feigned ignorance once again. He also refused to acknowledge Ravi Shankar's name. But his clouded face did not escape the interrogators' attention.[2]

Bhagyanathan played the interrogation well, particularly for a person who did not have any known criminal past. He admitted to owning the printing press but refused any association with the LTTE's Baby Subramaniam. He claimed he never bought the press from him. Ravi Shankar was brought into the room with clear instructions that he would have to pretend to not know Bhagyanathan. The SIT would just like to watch Bhagyanathan's reaction on seeing Shankar in the room. But Shankar failed to act as instructed and Bhagyanathan did his best to maintain a straight face. Shortly, Shankar was taken out of the room. Ragothaman showed Bhagyanathan the photographs again. The two girls, earlier identified by the informant, were especially brought to his attention. Bhagyanathan claimed he had never seen them. Verma then showed him the first photograph with the assassin girl and the kurta-pyjama-clad man. Bhagyanathan again denied knowing either of them. Both Verma and Ragothaman asked him repeatedly, but Bhagyanathan stuck to his answers.

His repeated denial of everything raised suspicion in the minds of the SIT members. It seemed to them that he was trying to hide something. Verma showed him the photos again and repeated the questions. Bhagyanathan, gaining confidence after being able to survive the interrogation that long, told Verma the SIT was wasting its time on innocent people such as him. Verma lost his cool, slapped Bhagyanathan hard and told Ragothaman to pick up Bhagyanathan's family, whoever was available.

Within an hour, Bhagyanathan's mother Padma was brought to Malligai. In front of her, Verma and Ragothaman cornered Bhagyanathan with a series of questions and faced him with the odds that were going against him. After a point, she broke down. Padma admitted that the girl in the picture was none other than Nalini, her daughter and Bhagyanathan's sister. The interrogators looked at Bhagyanathan in disbelief. He had done extraordinarily well in hiding his emotions when they were showing him a picture of his own sister.[3]